Mentoring the Fellow Craft

Second Degree · prompts for the Personal Mentor

Before, during and after his Passing. Sometimes called the forgotten degree; it should not be. The pace is his, never the calendar's.

1 PREPARE	■ Explain the timing, format and general structure of the evening, without giving away any ritual detail. ■ Make sure he knows the etiquette and dress code: punctuality, mobile phone off, cash for the raffle and charity. ■ Make sure he knows he will answer the questions in open Lodge, and offer help in practising them. ■ Practical reassurance: everyone has done this; arrive early, relax, and trust that the officers will guide and support him throughout.
2 GUIDE	■ Re-introduce him to the Tyler, the Inner Guard and the Junior Deacon. ■ Explain that advancement builds on the symbolic foundation laid in the First Degree. ■ Revisit the Masonic values of integrity, friendship, respect and service, and how they deepen through knowledge. ■ Expectations: attendance, contribution, charity, and active participation at the Festive Board and the Lodge of Instruction. ■ Encourage him to visit another Lodge's Second Degree.
3 SUPPORT	■ Explain that the Masonic journey continues beyond the Second Degree. ■ Reinforce that questions are encouraged: you, the officers and the Brethren are available after the ceremony. ■ Reassure him that ritual takes as long as each individual needs; he should not feel overwhelmed. ■ Reassure him that the ceremony is symbolic, dignified and entirely safe. ■ Begin to identify the areas of curiosity that will lead him towards his Third Degree. ■ Highlight the value of the Lodge of Instruction.
4 ENLIGHTEN	■ Discuss the moral and intellectual themes of the Second Degree: the pursuit of knowledge, the development of reason and the building of character. ■ Encourage reflection on how the lessons of diligence, study and self-improvement apply personally and professionally. ■ After the meeting, discuss the working tools of the first two degrees and their symbolic meaning. ■ After the meeting, discuss the apron and what the Master Mason's apron will signify. ■ Keep him on the Daily Advancement WhatsApp Group (DAWG), run by the Provincial Mentoring Team.

Companion to the Personal Mentor's Short Guide and the Stage Checklists · Never reveal ritual · Issue 1 (Draft for Review), October 2026 · © Provincial Grand Mentor, Province of Hertfordshire, 2026